

Verkada being a bad neighbor?

Dec 11, 2023



Editor,

Verkada has been refusing to comply with its requirement to open its parking garages at 405 E. Fourth Ave. and 406 E. Third Ave., even though its lease stipulates it, it was a condition of the building being approved (in exchange for benefits the developer and presumably the tenants would benefit from). Heck there are 3-foot square signs posted outside both garages serving as a daily reminder to anyone entering the properties.

Parking downtown is challenging, especially on nights and weekends. Our downtown businesses rely heavily on holiday traffic, and parking is desperately needed for families, and seniors, particularly with the colder, rainier weather we experience now. Verkada has known about this for over 40 days, via the developer and the city. We've reached out via social media, and have received no response, no ETA, and frustratingly, no access.

It raises the bigger question of developer concessions. Every project asks for waivers, concessions and/or bonuses, ostensibly for community benefit. With no one policing this, and if businesses like Verkada can seemingly ignore these requirements, one must ask — why are we granting these at all, and what will the impact be on our beloved city?

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